
Guidelines

Expert Annotation Instructions for Multimodal Healthcare Question Summarization

Trigger warning: The annotation process includes graphic content that may be potentially sensitive. These may include graphic depictions of diseases, infections, body parts, blood, and/or other sensitive content. Annotators are advised to proceed at their own discretion.

Use of AI systems while annotating: Please note that the use of AI systems such as ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, etc., is not permitted during any stage of the annotation process. You are free to use and consult online resources for acquiring relevant knowledge about the user/patient's condition. However, you are not permitted to use generative AI tools for writing the summaries, descriptions, or any other annotation output. If at any point it is suspected that the annotations were generated by generative AI, we reserve the right to withhold payment for those annotations.

Task goal: Convert a noisy healthcare-related user post, often with one or more images, into (1) an objective clinical description of the image including approximate measurements, (2) a concise multimodal clinical summary merging text and image findings. The outputs should capture what the user wants to know, not provide a diagnosis or medical advice.

clinical-annotation-tool.abhishek-basu2010.workers.dev

Required Annotation Tasks

	Task	Required Output
1	Objective Image Description	A factual clinical description of what is visible in the image, including approximate measurements or extent. Written independently of the user's text.
2	Full Multimodal Clinical Summary	A concise merged summary (typically one question or 2–3 short sentences) combining the user's text concern with image findings and measurements.

Task 1: Objective Image Description

Write a factual, clinical description of what is visible in the image, as if describing it to a colleague who cannot see it. Written independently of the user's text.

Include approximate measurements or extent within this description whenever they can be reasonably estimated. Measurements are part of the image description, not a separate field.

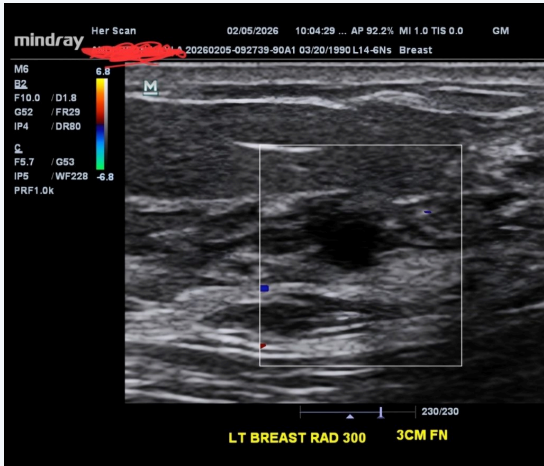
Rules

- Describe only what is objectively visible in the image.
- Do not reference the user's text, story, symptoms, or stated concern.
- Use descriptive language: color, shape, size, texture, location, distribution, borders, symmetry. [\(reference\)](#)
- Use uncertainty-aware phrasing: *"appears to show," "consistent with," "possible."*
- If the image is a report/lab screenshot, describe the key visible values.

Measurement Rules (Within This Description)

- Include approximate size, count, location, or spread when reasonably estimable.
- Use approximate language: *"about," "approximately," "small," "large," "localized," "diffuse."*
- Do not invent exact sizes until it is explicitly mentioned in the image.
- If a report provides a measurement, preserve the exact report value.
- If countable lesions, approximate the count.
- If diffuse, describe extent instead of size.

Examples

Image	Original Question	Objective Image Description (with measurements)
	Need Stitches? 29M 5'9 143lbs No daily Meds, No allergies, vape daily, No recent medical issues. Cut my Finger on a bread knife, cleaned it applied triple antibiotic and wrapped it trying to avoid an urgent care visit. Happened on Thursday night, doesn't seem to be healing in the way I'd hoped. https://imgur.com/a/JIXW5IE From the next day. https://imgur.com/a/OgSMpoX This is today. Not sure if it's healing right just want a second opinion	Linear laceration approximately 1.5–2 cm on the palmar left index finger. Wound edges slightly separated. Mild erythema extending about 5 mm from margins. No purulence or active bleeding. Finger callus-like spots
	Breast ultrasound 3 images Just did a breast ultrasound. It says im a level 4 and need follow up. Im 35. 2 kids. Heterogeneous background echotexture. There is a 3 x 3 x 3 mm hypoechoic cyst versus solid mass in the left breast at the 3 o'clock position 3 cm from the nipple posterior depth. The finding is taller than wide. Margins are	The image/report shows a 3 x 3 x 3 mm hypoechoic cyst versus solid mass in the left breast at the 3 o'clock position, 3 cm from the nipple. The report describes the finding as taller than wide, with partially circumscribed and partially indistinct/angular margins.

	partially circumscribed and partially indistinct and angular. No internal color Doppler flow. Small amount of posterior acoustic shadowing. https://imgur.com/a/leOabPC I have my diagnostic mammogram and ultrasound tomorrow. Just want to get an idea of what they are potentially seeing in these scans. Thanks for any insight/feedback.	
--	--	--

Task 2: Full Multimodal Clinical Summary

Write a concise clinical summary that combines the user's main text concern with the objective image findings from Task 1. The goal is to create a doctor-friendly summary that clearly captures what the user wants to know while including the most relevant visual information.

This output should usually be **one combined clinical question**. Use **2–3 short sentences** only when the case is too complex to fit clearly into one question.

Rules

- Capture the user's main concern and important subquestions.
- Integrate relevant text details with the image findings from Task 1.
- Use third-person wording. Avoid **I, my, me, we, our**.
- Keep wording concise, simple, and clinically useful.
- Preserve important numerical details from the text and image.
- Include demographics only when clinically useful.
- Include user-stated measurements, lab values, report values, medication doses, timing, duration, pregnancy weeks, age, weight, or other relevant numbers.
- **Include image-based findings and approximate measurements only when they are important to the user's question.**
- Do not answer the question.
- Do not give advice, reassurance, triage instructions, or treatment recommendations.
- Do not introduce speculative diagnoses that are not mentioned by the user or supported by the visible image/report.

What to Include

Detail Type	Guideline
User's main question	Always include the central ask: "What is this?", "Is this infected?", "Need ER?", "Cancer?", "Normal?"
Age and sex	Include when clinically useful, especially for children, pregnancy, elderly, sex-specific concerns.
Key symptoms	Major symptoms, duration, worsening, pain, fever, bleeding, swelling, or functional limitation.
User-stated numbers	Age, duration, weight, temperature, medication dose, lab values, report measurements, pregnancy weeks, injury timing. If the user writes it in their post, keep it.
Relevant medications / history	Only when related to the concern: anticoagulants with bleeding, antibiotics with infection, pregnancy, immune conditions, surgery.
Image findings	Include visible findings from the image such as redness, swelling, wound edges, rash distribution, lesion color, approximate size, count, location, or report values.

What to Exclude

- Emotional language, panic, apologies, gratitude, or long personal background unless clinically necessary.
- Irrelevant demographics that do not help understand the clinical question.
- Speculative diagnoses not mentioned by the user or not clearly supported by the image/report.
- Medical advice, reassurance, triage instructions, or treatment recommendations.
- Full patient history unless needed to understand the question.
- Overly precise image measurements when no info is available.

Examples

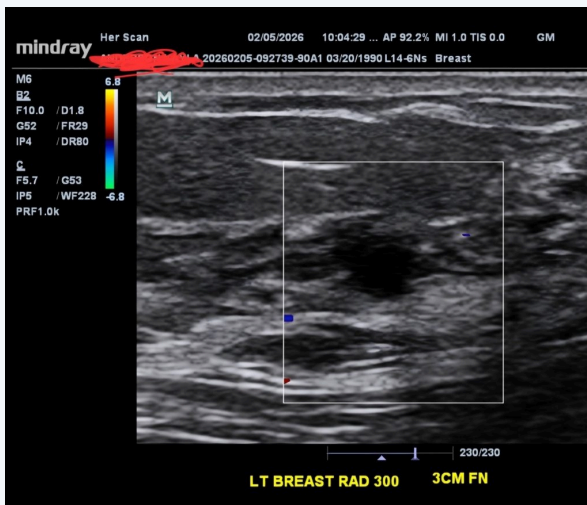
Image	Original Question	Full Multimodal Clinical Summary
-------	-------------------	----------------------------------



Need Stitches?

29M 5'9 143lbs No daily Meds, No allergies, vape daily, No recent medical issues. Cut my Finger on a bread knife, cleaned it applied triple antibiotic and wrapped it trying to avoid an urgent care visit. Happened on Thursday night, doesn't seem to be healing in the way I'd hoped. <https://imgur.com/a/JIXW5IE> From the next day. <https://imgur.com/a/OgSMpoX> This is today. Not sure if it's healing right just want a second opinion

Does a 29-year-old male with an approximately 1.5–2 cm bread-knife laceration on the left index finger, showing slightly separated wound edges and mild erythema about 5 mm from margins after 3 days, need stitches or wound care evaluation?



Breast ultrasound 3 images

Just did a breast ultrasound. It says im a level 4 and need follow up. Im 35. 2 kids. Heterogeneous background echotexture.

There is a 3 x 3 x 3 mm hypoechoic cyst versus solid mass in the left breast at the 3 o'clock position 3 cm from the nipple posterior depth. The finding is taller than wide. Margins are partially circumscribed and partially indistinct and angular. No internal color Doppler flow. Small amount of

What are they potentially seeing in a 3 x 3 x 3 mm hypoechoic cyst versus solid mass in the left breast at the 3 o'clock position, 3 cm from the nipple, level 4?

	posterior acoustic shadowing. https://imgur.com/a/leQabPC I have my diagnostic mammogram and ultrasound tomorrow. Just want to get an idea of what they are potentially seeing in these scans. Thanks for any insight/feedback.	
--	--	--